

month. 2. And there they carried off Dinah, the daughter of Jacob, into the house of Shechem, the son of Hamor, the Hivite, the prince of the land, and he lay with her and defiled her, and she was a little girl, a child of twelve years. 3. And he besought his father and her brothers that she might be given to him to wife. And Jacob and his sons were wroth because of the men of Shechem; for they had defiled Dinah, their sister, and they spake to them with evil intent and dealt deceitfully with them and beguiled them. 4. And Simeon and Levi came unexpectedly to Shechem and executed judgment on all the men of Shechem, and

peace. This passage is based on Gen. xxxiii. 18 שלם יעקב ייבש. The LXX, Syr., Eusebius, and Jerome here take שלם as a proper name. The Sam. reads שלם. Our text combines both interpretations.

To the east. Gen. xxxiii. 18 has "city."

2-3. Cf. Gen. xxxiv. 2, 4, 7, 13.

2-6. The history of Jacob's connection with the Shechemites caused much trouble to our author. He could hardly approve of their slaughter after they had consented to circumcision. Accordingly he omits all reference to the circumcision of the Shechemites, as also does Josephus (*Ant.* i. 21. 1). On the other hand this is given as the reason for Jacob's anger against Simeon and Levi in Test. Levi 6: καὶ ἤκουσεν ὁ πατήρ, καὶ ὠργίσθη, καὶ ἐλυπήθη, ὅτι κατεδέξαντο τὴν περιτομὴν καὶ μετὰ ταῦτα ἀπέθανον. Notwithstanding the severe disapprobation of Simeon and Levi in Gen. xlix. 5-7 for their conduct in this matter, it was highly extolled in the two centuries preceding the Christian era. This is done in our text and in Test. Levi 5 where the angel bids Levi: πόλῃσον ἐκδίκησιν ἐν Συχέμ ὑπὲρ Δίνας, κἀγὼ ἔσομαι μετὰ σου, ὅτι κύριος ἀπέσταλκέ με. καὶ συνετέλεσα τῷ καιρῷ ἐκείνῳ τοὺς υἱοὺς Ἑμμώρ, καθὼς γέγραπται ἐν ταῖς πλάξι τῶν οὐρανῶν: and in the Test. Levi 6-7, where Levi says that he saw that "the sentence of God had gone forth for evil against Shechem," and still more strongly:

ἔφθασε δὲ ἡ ὀργὴ κυρίου ἐπ' αὐτοὺς εἰς τέλος. Again in Judith (a Hebrew work of the first cent. B.C.) ix. 2: κύριε ὁ θεὸς τοῦ πατρὸς μου Συμεὼν, ᾧ ἔδωκας ἐν χειρὶ ῥομφαίαν εἰς ἐκδίκησιν ἀλλογενῶν, οἱ ἔλυσαν μήτραν παρθένου εἰς μίasma καὶ ἐγύμνωσαν μηρὸν εἰς ἀσχύνην, κ.τ.λ. Again in Philo, *De Migr. Abrahami*, 39, Simeon and Levi are called οἱ φρονήσεως ἀκουσταὶ καὶ γνώριμοι for their action in this matter, and in the next few lines it is implied that Shechem was not circumcised. See also the Book of Jashar for a reproduction of the ancient favourable view of Simeon and Levi (*Dict. des Apocr.* ii. 1166-1168). In the late rabbinic tradition, however, Simeon and Levi are judged more in accordance with the sentence pronounced upon them in Gen. xlix. In Gen. rabba 80, it is true, there is some extenuation of their conduct; but in section 98 of the same work it is said that the fact that most of the poor were of the tribe of Simeon is to be traced to the curse in Gen. xlix. 7. Singer (p. 115 note) compares also Sifre on Deut. xxxiii. 8.

2. *Child of twelve years.* This agrees with the reckoning in Test. Levi 12. There Levi, who was six years older than Dinah, slew Shechem at the age of eighteen.

3. *His father (ab).* cd "her father." *And beguiled them.* *And Simeon . . . to Shechem.* Latin has: Et posuerunt in corde suo Symeon et Lenui exterminare eos.

4. Cf. Gen. xxxiv. 25-27.

slew all the men whom they found in it, and left not a single one remaining in it: they slew all in torments because they had dishonoured their sister Dinah. 5. And thus let it not again be done from henceforth that a daughter of Israel be defiled; for judgment is ordained in heaven against them that they should destroy with the sword all the men of the Shechemites because they had wrought shame in Israel. 6. And the Lord delivered them into the hands of the sons of Jacob that they might exterminate them with the sword and execute judgment upon them, and that it might not thus again be done in Israel that a virgin of Israel should be defiled. 7. And if there is any man who wishes in Israel to give his daughter or his sister to any man who is of the seed of the Gentiles he shall surely die, and they shall stone him with stones; for he hath wrought shame in Israel; and they shall burn the woman with fire, because she has dishonoured the name of the house of her father, and she shall be rooted out of Israel. 8. And let not an adulteress and no uncleanness be found in Israel throughout all the days of the generations of the earth; for Israel is holy unto the Lord, and every man who has defiled (it) shall surely die: they shall stone him with stones. 9. For thus has it been ordained and written in the heavenly tables regarding all the seed of Israel: he

5. *Wrought shame in Israel.* Cf. Gen. xxxiv. 7.

7. This statement does not agree quite with any in the O.T. The burning of the woman with fire, it is true, finds a precedent in Gen. xxxviii. 24, where Judah demands that such a punishment should be executed on Tamar—a punishment at variance with the later law in Lev. xxi. 9. See in note on xli. 17 the distortion of the biblical tradition had recourse to by the Rabbis in order to justify the demand of Judah. It is true that her crime is that of fornication, whereas our text deals merely with the marriage of a Hebrew woman and a Gentile. To

our author, however, such a marriage was illegal and was no better than fornication. In Lev. xxi. 9 it is ordained that a priest's daughter who played the harlot was to be burnt with fire. Our text teaches that to give a daughter to a non-Israelite was to give her to Moloch (cf. ver. 10). Since our author holds the former to be equivalent to the latter, it follows that the man who was guilty of the former offence should justly be visited with the penalty exacted for the latter, and this was, according to Lev. xx. 2, death by stoning; hence our text ordains: "and they shall stone him with stones."

who defileth (it) shall surely die, and he shall be stoned with stones. 10. And to this law there is no limit of days, and no remission, nor any atonement: but the man who has defiled his daughter shall be rooted out in the midst of all Israel, because he has given of his seed to Moloch, and wrought impiously so as to defile it. 11. And do thou, Moses, command the children of Israel and exhort them not to give their daughters to the Gentiles, and not to take for their sons any of the daughters of the Gentiles, for this is abominable before the Lord. 12. For this reason I have written for thee in the words of the Law all the deeds of the Shechemites, which they wrought against Dinah, and how the sons of Jacob spake, saying: "We shall not give our daughter to a man who is uncircumcised; for that were a reproach unto us." 13. And it is a reproach to Israel, to those who give, and to those who take the daughters of the Gentiles; for this is unclean and abominable to Israel. 14. And Israel will not be free from this uncleanness if it has a wife of the daughters of the Gentiles, or has given any of its

10. *Has given of his seed to Moloch.* This interpretation of Lev. xviii. 21: "Thou shalt not give any of thy seed to make them pass through the fire to Molech," as being equivalent to giving one's child in marriage to a Gentile, is found in Ps.-Jon. on this verse: "And of thy seed thou shalt not give to lie with a daughter of the Gentiles so as to draw him over to a strange worship." The Latin which gives *alienigenae* instead of *Molech* is an interpretation of the text but not the text itself. The same idea underlies the statement in Sanh. 82a: R. Chija b. Abija said: "Whoever cohabits with a Gentile woman is to be regarded as though he had made himself the son-in-law of the idol; for it is said: And he cohabited with the daughter of a strange God." In Sanh. ix. 6 it enacts that "the zealous may slay a man taken in fornication with a Gentile or Roman woman (ארמית)." Nearly the same statement as is quoted above from Ps.-Jon. is found

in Megilla 25a. That such an interpretation was prevalent we see from Megil. iv. 9: האומר מורעך לא תתן להעביר למולך ומורעך לא תתן לאעבד בארמיותא = "Whoever translates 'Thou shalt not give of thy seed to pass through the fire to Molech' as 'Thou shalt not give of thy seed to cohabit with a Gentile woman,' bid him be silent." Singer (p. 200 note) says that this Mishna is directed against the Jewish Christians. However this may be, the interpretation was an ancient Jewish one to begin with. It may not be older than the Maccabean age. The circumstances of that time were such as to justify the extremest measures in order to save Judaism from annihilation.

11. *For their sons.* So Latin. *bcd* om., but *a* = *avrol*.

12. *We shall not give, etc.* Cf. Gen. xxxiv. 14.

14-15. The sin of one man, the man who gives any of his seed to the Gentiles

daughters to a man who is of any of the Gentiles. 15. For there will be plague upon plague, and curse upon curse, and every judgment and plague and curse will come (upon him): if he do this thing, or hide his eyes from those who commit uncleanness, or those who defile the sanctuary of the Lord, or those who profane His holy name, (then) will the whole nation together be judged for all the uncleanness and profanation of this (man). 16. And there will be no respect of persons [and no consideration of persons], and no receiving at his hands of fruits and offerings and burnt-offerings and fat, nor the fragrance of sweet savour, so as to accept it: and so fare every man or woman in Israel who defiles the sanctuary. 17. For this reason I have commanded thee, saying: "Testify this testimony to Israel: see how the Shechemites fared and their sons: how they were delivered into the hands of two sons of Jacob, and they slew them under tortures, and it was (reckoned) unto them for righteousness, and it is written down to them for righteousness. 18. And the seed of Levi was chosen for

or takes to wife a Gentile woman will affect the whole community. These verses are based on Lev. xx. 2-4, which deal with the man who gives his seed unto Moloch.

15. (*Upon him*). Added from the Latin.

Hide his eyes. This is the phrase in Lev. xx. 4, חָעִיִּים עֵינָיו. The Latin, *praeterierit et despexerit*, seems to be a dittography.

Who commit uncleanness . . . defile the sanctuary of the Lord . . . profane His holy name. Cf. Lev. xx. 3, "Hath given of his seed unto Molech, to defile my sanctuary . . . to profane my holy name."

(*Then*) *will the whole nation together*, etc. In Lev. xx. 5 only the man's family is involved in his guilt. Our author's enlargement of the area of the guilt is to justify the action of Simeon and Levi in slaying all the Shechemites. Our text (ver. 2) makes the whole people share in the rape of Dinah. In

Test. Levi 6 a very evil account of them is given: οὕτως ἐδίδωξαν Ἀβραὰμ τὸν πατέρα ἡμῶν ξένον ὄντα, καὶ κατεπάτησαν τὰ πόλινια ὀγκομένα ὄντα ἐπ' αὐτόν· καὶ Ἰεβλαε τὸν οἰκογενῆ αὐτοῦ σφόδρα ἀκλίσαντο. καὶ γε οὕτως ἐπόλουν πάντας τοὺς ξένους, ἐν δυναστείᾳ ἀρπάζοντες τὰς γυναῖκας αὐτῶν.

All the uncleanness (a b and Latin). c d "all this uncleanness."

Profanation of this (man). MSS read "this profanation." I have emended in accordance with the Latin.

16. [*And no consideration of persons*]. Bracketed as a dittography. Latin omits.

The fragrance of sweet savour. Latin: odorabitur odore suavitatis.

18. The ground for Levi's appointment to the priesthood is quite different in xxxii. 3. Levi is there consecrated to the work of the priesthood as the tithe or tenth in Jacob's family. Our author has thus made use of two conflicting traditions. Possibly a third is

the priesthood, and to be Levites, that they might minister before the Lord, as we, continually, and that Levi and his sons may be blessed for ever; for he was zealous to execute righteousness and judgment and vengeance on all those who arose against Israel. 19. And so they inscribe as a testimony in his favour on the heavenly tables blessing and righteousness before the God of all: 20. And we remember the righteousness which the man fulfilled during his life, at all periods of the year; until a thousand generations they will record it, and it will come to him and to his descendants after him, and he has been recorded on the heavenly tables as a friend and a righteous man. 21. All this account I have written for thee, and have commanded thee to say to the children of Israel, that they should not commit sin nor transgress the ordinances nor break the covenant which has been ordained for them, (but) that they should fulfil it and be recorded as friends. 22. But if they transgress and work uncleanness in every way, they will be recorded on the heavenly tables as adversaries, and they will be destroyed out of the book of life, and they will be recorded in the book of those who will be destroyed and with those who will be rooted out of the earth. 23. And on the day when the sons of Jacob slew Shechem a writing was recorded in their favour in heaven that they had executed righteousness and uprightness and

to be found in Test. Levi 4, where Levi's appointment seems to be in answer to his prayer: εἰσήκουσεν οὖν ὁ ὑψιστος τῆς προσευχῆς σου τοῦ διελεῖν σε ἀπὸ τῆς ἀδικίας καὶ γενέσθαι αὐτῷ . . . λειτουργὸν τοῦ προσώπου αὐτοῦ. Another tradition appears in Shem. rabba 19 to the effect that Levi received the priesthood because it held fast to the rite of circumcision in Egypt when all the other tribes neglected it (Weber, *Jüd. Theol.*² p. 309). For other reasons cf. Baba bathra 123 a and Bamidbar rabba 7. See Singer (p. 115 note).

19. *God of all.* See note on xxii. 4.

20. *Friend, i.e., of God.* See note on xix. 9.

22. *Transgress.* Latin adds testamentum.

Book of life. See note on this expression in my edition of Eth. Enoch xlvii. 3. It may mean here the register of those who enjoy *temporal* blessings, but, in xxxvi. 10, of those who enjoy *eternal*.

Book of those who will be destroyed and. Latin has libro perditionum.

vengeance on the sinners, and it was written for a blessing. 24. And they brought Dinah, their sister, out of the house of Shechem, and they took captive everything that was in Shechem, their sheep and their oxen and their asses, and all their wealth, and all their flocks, and brought them all to Jacob their father. 25. And he reproached them because they had put the city to the sword; for he feared those who dwelt in the land, the Canaanites and the Perizzites. 26. And the dread of the Lord was upon all the cities which are around about Shechem, and they did not rise to pursue after the sons of Jacob; for terror had fallen upon them.

Jacob goes to Bethel to offer sacrifice, 1-3 (cf. Gen. xxxv. 2-4, 7, 14). Isaac blesses Levi, 4-17, and Judah, 18-22. Jacob recounts to Isaac how God prospered him, 24. Jacob goes to Bethel with Rebecca and Deborah, 26-30. Jacob blesses the God of his fathers, 31-32.

XXXI. And on the new moon of the month Jacob spake to all the people of his house, saying: "Purify yourselves and change your garments, and let us arise and go up to Bethel, where I vowed a vow to Him on the day when I fled from the face of Esau my brother, because He has been with me and brought me into this land in peace, and put ye away the strange gods that are among

24. Cf. Gen. xxxiii. 26, 28.

And all their wealth. *c d* transpose after "flocks" against *a b* and Latin.

25. *Reproached them.* Text = ἐλάλησε πρὸς αὐτοὺς (so Latin, locutus est ad illos) = עָלַם לָהֶם, which, however, in this context the Greek translator should have rendered by ἐλάλησε κατ' αὐτῶν. The same wrong choice of the two possible renderings of this phrase is found also in the LXX of Jer. vi. 10,

xxv. 2, xxvi. 2, etc. I press the above correction of the translation because the context requires עָלַם לָהֶם and not עָלַם לָהֶם as in Gen. xxxiv. 30 in the corresponding passage. With our text "reproached them because they had put the city to the sword," cf. Test. Levi 6: οἱ ἀδελφοὶ ἐπάταξαν τὴν πόλιν ἐν στόματι ῥομφαίας. καὶ ἤκουσεν ὁ πατήρ, καὶ ὠργίσθη, καὶ ἐλυπήθη.

26. Cf. Gen. xxxv. 5.

XXXI. 1-2. Cf. Gen. xxxv. 2-4.